

DRAFT CARD — page 1 of 2: THE DRAFT

JUG, slot 8 · Mon Sept 7, 8:00 PM · keeper lock 7:00 PM · your keeper: George Pickens, bye 14

YOUR 14 SELECTIONS — THERE IS NO PICK 176

8 · 17 · 32 · 41 · 56 · 65 · 80 · 89 · 104 · 113 · 128 · 137 · 152 D/ST · 161 K

Pick 8: take the best player on the board.

Longest wait 17→32. Steepest losses 32→41. Pick 137 is your last real choice.

DO NOT DRAFT — and it is not just one name. Josh Jacobs is on the Commissioner's Exempt List and is held at zero on your board. **Every do-not-draft and every deliberate override is on the OVERRIDE CARD — desktop link 09.** Six players are on it. If ESPN's ranking disagrees with your board, that card is why.

POSITION DEADLINES — THE SHAPE OF YOUR DRAFT

The last turn where a **startable starter** at that position is still on the board. After it, everyone left there is below replacement.

65 WR — the earliest deadline. Fifteen picks before RB.

80 RB

89 QB and TE

104 from here on, **every** position is below replacement. This is the bench.

So: WR is the position you can run out of first. Not a rule to force — a clock to know.

ROSTER AND CAPS

Start **1QB · 2RB · 2WR · 1TE · 1FLEX · 1D/ST · 1K** · Bench 6 · IR 3

Your caps **QB2 · RB6 · WR6 · TE2** — tighter than the league's QB3/TE3, on purpose.

Every pick from round 5 is a keeper audition — he must be drafted and held all season; waiver pickups never qualify. Prefer a real 2027 role over three points.

DO NOT TAKE TWO FROM ONE ROW

Week 11 Bijan, Kyren, Judkins, Stafford, Adams

Week 13 Taylor, Jeanty, Henry, Hall, Bowers, Flowers, Warren

Week 14 Pickens, McBride, Jeremiyah Love

Your keeper is already week 14, so anything else at 14 doubles the hole.

Byes are a tiebreaker only — the worst collision on this board is worth 1.2 points. Never move a pick that has real margin behind it.

QB — ONE CLIFF, THEN FLAT

The top quarterback is **47 points** clear of the next — and he goes at or before pick 9, so he is not a choice you get to make. Everyone after him is bunched: **QB2 through QB6 span 12 points in total.**

There is no right round for a QB. Take one when the board offers value, not on a schedule.

TE — TWO PLAYERS, THEN NOTHING

Bowers +51 McBride +48 Warren +28 then LaPorta +9 and a long flat tail.

Never reach for TE4 or later. No TE has gone inside the first 17 picks in either of the last two drafts.

BENCH — 104, 113, 128, 137

RB until you hit the cap, then WR.

1,230 waiver moves say why: **your own** RB adds worked **20%** (39 tries, 4 seasons) — the best rate in the league, and still four misses in five. QB adds worked **36%**. **Draft the position waivers cannot save you at.**

No second TE.

SECOND QB — THIS RULE HAS FLIPPED SINCE THE LAST CARD.
At **104 or 113**, if a QB of **Goff's tier or better** is on the board, **take the QB2.** Take the RB only if no such QB is there, or if the RB is the better 2026 player by VBD.
The old card priced the RB you would skip at **+8** as next year's keeper. That was an assumption. Measured, a kept RB returns **+0.7** — so the 2027 keeper story is no longer a tiebreaker.
Your doctrine says RB/WR at a near-tie; the measurement says QB2 at these two picks. It is your roster — settle it before 8:00 PM, not at the table.

D/ST AND K

Picks 152 and 161. Never sooner. They are not on your board until then.

DRAFT CARD — page 2 of 2: THE SCREEN, AND IF IT BREAKS

Nothing on this page is a draft decision. It is how to read the board and how to recover.

READ PAGE 1 BEFORE THE DRAFT. READ THIS PAGE ONLY IF SOMETHING LOOKS WRONG.

READING THE SCREEN

VBD	how good he is, any position
adds now	what he adds to your lineup today
if I wait	best at that position next turn
Δ	how fast the position is drying up. Not the ranking.
cost vs #1	this is the ranking. free = take him
still there?	chance he lasts to your next pick
The big amber number is how much better row 1 is than row 2.	

Under 1.5 the engine cannot separate them — take row 1 anyway. Your read breaks a tie only *among* the rows already at the top, never over one the engine ranked below them.

THE TWO MARKS BESIDE A NAME

Left = a reason not to. Right = a reason to, on a tie. Hover for why. A red mark silences a green one.

LEFT worst wins	AVOID misses real time · OUT/IR · DISC a tier later · BYE clashes with your roster · FADE analysts out · Q
RIGHT + dots	BUY our panels ahead of ADP · CALLS analysts targeted him · DART backup, only from 104 · ok healthy

Dots count AGREEMENT, not value — more dots often goes with a worse player. They show only when the row is within 3 points of the top.

Carrying AVOID today: Josh Jacobs, George Kittle, J.K. Dobbins, Brian Thomas Jr., Kyle Monangai, Khalil Shakir, Zach Charbonnet, Tank Dell, Jordyn Tyson. Read off the board, not typed — if the screen and this list disagree, the screen is newer.

SWINGS — WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS

From pick 104 on, when two players are close, take the bigger upside over the safer floor. Any position — not a QB rule or an RB rule. Before 104 it costs \$22-41: take the better player.

Nothing on your board calculates “upside.” There is no ceiling number, and the analyst panels cannot supply one — four separate tests say so. **This is your call, and only on a near-tie.**

About **1 in 6** late picks returns far more than he cost, against 1 in 30 early — but only about **1 in 5** late picks ends up startable at all. **You are buying lottery tickets, not starters.** That is why this is a free option and not an edge.

The shape that keeps showing up is **a backup RB who inherits the job** — 8 of the last 15 late hits. Roughly **3-4** of your picks are true darts. Not all the late ones.

7:55 PM — BEFORE IT STARTS

The first poll line should report **12 keeper rows**. If it says 0, that is usually just ESPN — your board already has them removed, so keep going.

The real alarm comes later: if your pick number runs exactly **12 ahead** of ESPN's once picking starts, the keeper filter broke. Go to paper.

IF IT BREAKS

frozen or blank	use the printed board. Highest VBD that fits your caps. Ignore byes.
pick # off by 12	trust ESPN. Go to paper.
K or D/ST too early	wrong board loaded. Stop, run py check_kit.py .
offers a drafted guy	at 152/161 check the name against the room. Else refresh.
401 / 403	cookies. py cookie_jar.py — one command, it does the rest.
anything else	best VBD that fits your caps. Byes break ties only when nothing else does.

The board matters about 6x more than the pick rule. Losing the rule for a pick is survivable. Losing the board is not.